P310/2
LITERATURE IN ENGLISH
Paper 2
2026
3 hours

UGANDA NATIONAL EXAMINATIONS BOARD
Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

Paper 2
(Literary Creation)
3 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

This examination paper consists of **three** *items.*

Respond to **one** *item only.*

Any additional item(s) responded to will **not** *be scored.*

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Choose **one** *of the following items and respond to it as guided.*

Item 1:

While volunteering at your town's old library, you come across a dusty, neglected book tucked away on a forgotten shelf. As you pull it out, a yellowed letter slips quietly onto the floor. Curious, you pick it up and notice that it is dated twenty years ago and addressed to someone whose name you do not recognize. As you begin to read, you are drawn into the voice of the writer—a person whose words reveal deep emotions of regret, hope, or a secret never shared. In that moment, you become the central actor in this unfolding situation: The Finder, standing between the past and the present. The Writer emerges through the letter as a vivid presence, while the Intended Recipient remains a shadowy but important figure whose life may be affected by what you now know.

As events unfold, you find yourself emotionally affected by the letter. Its message, whether about lost love, unfulfilled dreams, forgiveness, or hidden truths, begins to feel personal. You reflect on the circumstances that might have prevented the letter from reaching its destination and consider the passage of time that has kept its contents hidden. The situation develops into a moral and emotional dilemma: should you keep the letter and its secret, attempt to find the intended recipient, or respond to its message in your own way? The setting may remain the quiet library, or you may extend it imaginatively to other spaces such as an old house, an attic, or even a modern digital context, depending on how you shape your narrative.

- The central challenge you must grapple with is the decision about what to do with the letter and how to interpret its significance. Your response should demonstrate a clear understanding of this dilemma and the emotional weight it carries.
- In creating your literary piece, you are expected to use appropriate literary techniques such as imagery, symbolism, tone, characterization, and, where relevant, dialogue.
- Your work should be well-structured according to the form you choose.

Task:

Drawing on the scenario above, create an original literary work that responds imaginatively and critically to the situation of the discovered letter and the moral dilemma it presents. You are required to choose **either** a Short Drama Piece (Skit) or A Short Story. Use **1,000-1,500** words

Item 2:

For a number of years, Primary Leaving Examination (PLE) results in most of the districts in the Eastern region of Uganda showed poor performance of pupils. On further analysis, it was discovered that most of those pupils did not know how to read and when interventions such as Early Grade Reading programmes were put in place, the region was considered for implementation of the programme. To counteract the poor reading skills at primary level, head teachers of secondary

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schools in your district have agreed to make reading a compulsory activity on the school timetables. However, they have realized that they do not have readers for the different levels of learners. They have also realized that most of the few readers in place have content that is abstract to the current generation. To get relevant readers, the District Literature Bureau in your area, in conjunction with the Reading Association of Uganda, have organised writing and reading competitions at school and then district levels. The move is in a bid to promote rapid and extensive reading in schools. The theme for the competitions is "*Focused You Win, Unfocused You Lose*". Your school has identified you and fourteen other students to participate in the writing competition.

Task:

Write a short story of **1,000-1,500** words on the theme of the day which you will submit as your contribution to the writing competition.

- In creating your literary piece, you are expected to use appropriate literary techniques such as imagery, symbolism, tone, characterization, and, where relevant dialogue.
- You should show creativity and originality, as well as coherence in the development of ideas.

Item 3:

In the wake of increasing incidences of drug abuse among school-going youth, and in a bid to fight this vice, a traveling theatre called 'Our Collective Responsibility' has organised a national programme called *Take Drama to the People*. Various school drama clubs will compete at district level where the club that will submit the winning play will receive an award. The overall aim of the programme is to sensitise the youth about the dangers of drug abuse among the youth, and to suggest solutions to that problem. Your school Drama Club has decided to participate in this competition. Each member of the club is supposed to submit a play for the competition.

Task:

You are excited by the prospect of saving the youth in your district from the above social problem through playwriting. Write a one-act play titled, 'Your Health is your Wealth' to be submitted for the competition described above.

- You may choose to set your story in a realistic environment such as a street, school, or explore a more imaginative setting, depending on how you wish to develop the drama.
- Your work should demonstrate a clear understanding of the scenario using appropriate dramatic techniques including imagery, symbolism, tone, characterization, and others as may be necessary.
- You should structure your response effectively according to the chosen form that captures the piece that presents interactions through dialogue and stage directions that develops a clear and engaging plot.
- Your writing should be original, coherent, and creatively developed.

END

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CREATIVE WRITING (LITERARY CREATION)

The candidate is expected to:

- *Write a prose/drama piece.*
- *Apply appropriate literary style.*
- *Provide an appropriate plot/events of the story.*
- *Create appropriate characters that suit their roles.*
- *Provide a suitable title to the literary work.*
- *Provide appropriate setting.*
- *Explore realistic ideas about society and human nature.*
- *Present original and logical work.*

ITEM 1:

Expected Response

Candidate writes an original skit/ short play/ short story. Gives it a suitable title, choose setting which may be a library (the candidate describes the state of the books in the different shelves, a librarian's office, the reading place, etc), may use a chronological story line, creates suitable characters such as the librarian, students, public readers, the Writer of the letter, the Finder of the letter etc, the idea of (lost love, unfulfilled dreams, forgiveness or hidden truths) all through the story and uses appropriate dramatic techniques such as dialogue, gives relevant stage directions, dresses the characters in appropriate costumes, an old letter, etc

ITEM 2:

Expected Response

Candidate writes an original short story. Gives it the title: *Focused you win, Unfocused you lose*: may use a chronological story line from beginning, climax and resolution: creates suitable characters such as different kinds of students(serious and unserious ones) business men/women in communities (the successful and unsuccessful ones), student leaders, politicians, girls in school, etc: creates ideas that appeal to the youth that are related to the theme will be accepted (love, education): and uses appropriate narrative techniques such as dialogue, description, monologue, omniscient or 3rd person narrator, satire, etc.: chooses an appropriate setting.

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ITEM 3:

Expected Response

Candidate writes an original skit/ short play. Gives it a suitable title: *Your Health is your Wealth*: chooses setting which is appropriate (a street, slum, school, club/bar, dormitory, hospital/psychiatry/rehabilitation center which may be the source of drugs or healing place): presents appropriate incidents that make up the story: creates suitable characters such as students, teachers, gamblers, drug dealers, church leaders, medical personnel or police: the idea(s) of (effects of drugs, mental illness, failure in education) should be reflected all through the story and uses appropriate dramatic techniques such as dialogue, gives relevant stage directions, dresses the characters in appropriate costumes,

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